

Alayna Rowell, M.A., CCC-SLP

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<https://rowellalayna.github.io/blog.html>

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy , Communication Sciences; Clinical Research Certificate Case Western Reserve University	In Progress
Master of Arts , Speech-Language Pathology University of Toledo, Magna Cum Laude Graduate Assistantship	2017 – 2019
Bachelor of Arts , Speech and Hearing Science with Neuroscience minor Ohio State University, Magna Cum Laude with research distinction Health Sciences Scholar	2013 – 2017

SKILLS

EPIC (electronic health record system), clinical and instrumental evaluation of swallowing (modified barium swallow study, fiberoptic endoscopic evaluation of swallowing), R & R Studio, Quarto, Python, lingual monofilament sensory testing, surface electromyography (sEMG), functional near-infrared spectroscopy (fNIRS), Cedalion, Satori, lingual manometry including Iowa Oral Performance Instrument (IOPI)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Research Assistant Brain in Swallowing and Communication Lab	2024 - Present
• Manage and analyze data from multiple multisite projects • Establish and sustain community collaborations for dysphagia awareness, resource sharing, and participant recruitment • Conduct scoping and systematic reviews • Maintain and operate neuroimaging and electrophysiologic equipment • Mentor undergraduate and graduate students in literature reviews, manuscript writing, poster preparations, and clinical rotations	
Cleveland Clinic Lerner College of Medicine at Case Western Reserve University	2024 - Present
• Design and conduct electronic health record study with gastroenterology	
Graduate Research Assistant	2017 – 2019
<u>Project</u> : Investigation of the effects of an early intervention program, paired with biweekly feedback from a LENA recording device, on the language environment of children from low socioeconomic backgrounds	
• Managed treatment group schedules • Analyzed recordings of language samples • Designed parent handouts with data visualizations and therapeutic recommendations • Collaborated with the East Toledo Family Center for recruitment, staff training for early language intervention principles, and language feedback reports	

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Driving Simulation Lab

2016 – 2017

Projects: 1) Investigation of the internal and behavioral reactions to aggression during a driving simulation task as affected by neutral-content or aggressive-content bumper stickers; 2) Investigation of navigation and console touchscreen technology for industry partners

- Collaborated with engineering students to create a simulation environment
- Created standardized protocols and scripts
- Moderated driving simulation studies, acquired data and ran participants
- Prepared and presented undergraduate thesis

Language, Assistive Technology and Autism Lab

2015 – 2017

- Completed reliability testing to code eye gaze behaviors, investigating visual attention and memory behaviors during language learning tasks in young children with autism

POSTERS AND PRESENTATIONS

Rowell, A., Kamarunas, E., Szykiewicz, S., & Mulheren, R., on behalf of the ALLFTD Consortium. (2026). *Phenotype and Motor Deficits as Predictors of Dysphagia Symptoms in Frontotemporal Degeneration*. Dysphagia Research Society Annual Conference, Aurora, CO.

Rowell, A., & Mulheren, R. (2026). *Neurofilament light chain in neurogenic conditions at risk for dysphagia*. Dysphagia Research Society Annual Conference, Aurora, CO.

Mulheren, R., Szykiewicz, S., **Rowell, A.,** Kamarunas, E., & Drulia, T. (2026). *Characterizing tongue endurance in Parkinson's disease*. Dysphagia Research Society Annual Conference, Aurora, CO.

Steer, K., **Rowell, A.,** Shune, S., Navasivayam-MacDonald, A., & Mulheren, R. (2026). *Caring Beyond the NICU: The Effect of Pediatric Feeding/Swallowing on Caregiver Burden and Quality of Life*. Dysphagia Research Society Annual Conference, Aurora, CO.

Mulheren, R., & **Rowell, A.** (2025). *Mixed Reality in Anatomy Education*. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association Annual Conference, Washington, D.C.

Bailey, E., **Rowell, A.,** & Mulheren, R. (2025). *Dysphagia in Individuals with Behavioral Variant of Frontotemporal Degeneration-A Scoping Review*. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association Annual Conference, Washington, D.C.

Rowell, A., & Mulheren, R., on behalf of the ALLFTD Consortium. (2025). *Dysphagia Symptoms in Frontotemporal Degeneration: A Retrospective Analysis*. American Congress of Rehabilitation Medicine Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.

Rowell, A. (2025). *Dysphagia in frontotemporal lobar degeneration (FTLD): Exploring biomarkers to enhance care*. Three Minute Thesis Competition at Case Western Reserve University, Cleveland, OH.

Rowell, A., Kaleel, A., Diehm, E., & Pakulski, L. (2019). *Effects of a Technology-Enhanced Early Intervention Program*. Ohio Speech Language Hearing Association Conference, Columbus, OH.

***Rowell, A.,** Kerwin, T., Bushman, B., & Weisenberger, J. (2017). *Effects of Exposure to Aggressive Bumper Stickers on Driving Behavior*. Denman Undergraduate Research Forum, Columbus, OH.

*Awarded first place in its category

MANUSCRIPTS SUBMITTED

Bailey, E., **Rowell, A.**, & Mulheren, R. Dysphagia in Behavioral Variant of Frontotemporal Dementia: A Systematic Review. Submitted to *Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis and Frontotemporal Degeneration* in December 2025.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Rowell, A., Kamarunas, E., Szykiewicz, S., & Mulheren, R., on behalf of the ALLFTD Consortium. *Dysphagia symptoms reported in Frontotemporal Degeneration: Predictors and Limiting factors*. Planning to submit April 2026.

Rowell, A., Pulis, M., & Mulheren, R. *The effect of cuing on swallow initiation – A systematic review*. Planning to submit May 2026.

Rowell, A., & Mulheren, R. *Neurofilament light chain in neurogenic conditions at risk for dysphagia*. Planning to submit July 2026.

HONORS AND DISTINCTIONS

Research-Mentor Pair Travel Award <i>American Speech-Language-Hearing Association, \$2000</i>	2025
Graduate Student Scholarship <i>ASHFoundation, \$5000</i>	2025
Graduate Student Appreciation Award <i>School of Graduate Studies, Case Western Reserve University</i>	2025
CSDRG Logemann Conference Bursary <i>Dysphagia Research Society, \$500</i>	2024
Award for Continuing Education <i>American Speech-Language-Hearing Association</i>	2022
Graduate Student Scholarship finalist <i>Ohio Speech-Language-Hearing Association</i>	2018
Janet Weisenberger Undergraduate Research Writing Award <i>Speech & Hearing department, The Ohio State University</i>	2017
Denman Research Poster Award: First Place in Social and Behavioral Sciences category <i>The Ohio State University</i>	2017
Arts and Sciences Undergraduate Research Scholarship <i>The Ohio State University, \$2500</i>	2016
Undergraduate Student Research Grant <i>The Ohio State University, \$1000</i>	2016

SERVICE

Facilitator, <i>Communication Sciences Reading Group</i>	2024 – Present
Conference abstract reviewer, <i>American Speech-Language-Hearing Association</i>	2025
Judge, <i>Undergraduate Capstone Poster Presentations</i>	2024 – Present
Reviewer, <i>Undergraduate SOURCE Grant</i>	2025
Vice President, <i>Northwest Ohio Speech-Language-Hearing Association</i>	2019 – 2022

TEACHING

Instructor of Record <i>Undergraduate PSCL 390: Sensation & Swallowing in Aging and Healthcare</i>	Planned Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant <i>Undergraduate COSI 325: Anatomy and Physiology of Speech & Hearing Mechanism</i>	Fall 2025
Guest Lecturer <i>Graduate ANAT 414: Neurological Anatomy, on the neuroanatomy of speech, voice, and swallowing</i>	Fall 2025

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Dysphagia Research Society	2023 – present
The Informed SLP	2022 – present
American Speech-Language-Hearing Association	2019 – present

CERTIFICATIONS

Clinical Research Certificate <i>Case Western Reserve University School of Medicine, Department of Population and Quantitative Health Sciences</i>	In Progress
Certificate of Clinical Competence in Speech-Language Pathology <i>American Speech-Language-Hearing Association</i>	Renewed Yearly
Basic Life Support CPR & AED <i>American Heart Association</i>	Expires 10/2027
State license in speech-language pathology <i>Ohio</i>	Expires 12/31/2026
Modified Barium Swallow Impairment Profile <i>Northern Speech Services</i>	Expires 06/28/2026
Montreal Cognitive Assessment	Expires 07/01/2027

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Bronson, Southwest Michigan

December 2022 – July 2024

- Adult outpatient, satellite hospitals, & Level 1 Trauma hospital.

ProMedica, Sylvania, OH

June 2019 – November 2022

- Level 3 Trauma hospital & outpatient Neurosciences Center.

Kingston Rehabilitation, Perrysburg, OH

June 2021 – November 2022

- Skilled nursing facility.

P.T. Services Rehabilitation, Inc., Tiffin, OH

June 2019 – August 2021

- Adult and pediatric outpatient, community hospital, high school, skilled nursing facility, behavioral health hospital, telehealth.